

Flowing along the coast of South Africa, Namibia and Angola, the Benguela current is the eastern boundary of a large gyre in the South Atlantic Ocean. The current mixes water from the Atlantic and Indian Oceans as they meet off the capes of South Africa.

4. **Where does the El Niño current flow?**

- (a) The Pacific Ocean
- (b) The Indian Ocean
- (c) The Bay of Bengal
- (d) More than one of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

According to the observatory of NASA, the El Niño is evident in the eastward flowing wind in the tropical western and central Pacific. El Niño means little boy in Spanish. South American fishermen first noticed periods of unusually warm water in the Pacific Ocean.

5. **Which of the following currents is not a warm current?**

- (a) Alaska Current
- (b) Mozambique Current
- (c) Antilles Current
- (d) None of the above

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Ans. (d)

Warm currents bring warm water into cold water areas and are usually observed on the east coast of continents in the low and middle latitudes (true in both hemispheres). In the northern hemisphere they are found on the west coasts of continents in high latitudes. Alaska, Mozambique and Antilles currents are warm currents. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.

Salinity of the Ocean

1. **Main Source of Salinity of the Sea is –**

- (a) Rivers
- (b) Land
- (c) Wind
- (d) Ash ejected from the Volcano

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Main source of the salinity of sea water is the land. While rivers bring various types of salt contents towards the sea, other factors which regulate the salinity of the sea are vaporisation, wind, river water, rain, oceanic currents and the volcano etc. Average salinity of the sea is about 35‰.

2. **Which of the following seas has the highest average salinity?**

- (a) Black Sea
- (b) Yellow Sea
- (c) Mediterranean Sea
- (d) Dead Sea
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Among the given options Dead Sea has the highest average salinity (238‰). Assal Lake has the highest average salinity in the world i.e. 348‰.

3. **The average salinity of water of Arabian Sea is-**

- (a) 25 ppt
- (b) 35 ppt
- (c) 45 ppt
- (d) 55 ppt

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Between 0°-10° latitudes in the Indian Ocean, the salinity is 35.14‰ but in the Bay of Bengal, it decreases to 30‰. At the same time salinity of Arabian Sea is found to be 36‰ because of comparatively dry weather, more vaporization takes place and water brought by rivers is also less. Therefore, option (b) is correct.

High Tide, Low Tide

1. **The high tide in the Ocean is caused by**

- (a) Earthquake
- (b) Sun
- (c) Stars
- (d) Moon

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

Spring-tide occurs in the ocean on the day of Full Moon or New Moon while at 7th or 8th day after the Full Moon and the New Moon neap-tide occurs. Since, the Moon is nearer to the Earth in comparison to other stars, so its gravitational force has a greater effect upon the Earth. Due to this effect, high sea waves are produced in oceans. Tide producing power of the moon is 2.17 times more than the Sun.

Rivers of the World

1. **Which of the following are rivers?**

- (a) Victoria and Chad
- (b) Murray and Darling
- (c) Suez and Panama
- (d) Erie and Huron
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)